

SCHOOL MONITORING, EVALUATION & CERTIFICATION SYSTEM

Baseline | Monitoring | Evaluation | Quality Assurance | Certification

Coverage	Nursery through SSS 1-3.
Certification basis	Safe operations + instructional quality + learner evidence + assessment integrity + continuous improvement.
Scoring	Eight weighted domains; 0-4 item rubric; maximum weighted score 100.
Critical gate	Serious unresolved safety/safeguarding issues can block certification regardless of numerical score.

CERTIFICATION DOMAIN WEIGHTS

Code	Domain	Weight	Scope
D1	Leadership & Readiness	10%	School leadership, coordinator, timetable, roles, records and implementation readiness.
D2	Garden Operations & Safety	15%	Functional gardens, water, tools, maintenance, hygiene, safeguarding and incident control.
D3	Teacher Delivery Quality	20%	Learning objectives, vocabulary, demonstrations, practical work, questioning, differentiation and lesson closure.
D4	Learner Participation & Practical Competence	15%	Meaningful participation, safe practical performance and learner ownership of evidence.
D5	Investigation, Data & Problem Solving	15%	Observation, measurement, data quality, analysis, missions and evidence-based decisions.
D6	Food Literacy & Resource Stewardship	10%	Ingredient Lab, Farm-to-Food, Food Smart Challenges, water/waste/resource decisions.
D7	Assessment, Passport & Moderation	10%	Assessment completion, rubric use, moderation, feedback, reassessment and passport verification.
D8	Reporting, Improvement & Community Engagement	5%	Term reporting, corrective action, evidence use, approved community engagement and continuous improvement.

1. PURPOSE

Purpose	Provide a school-level system for baseline assessment, implementation monitoring, learning evaluation, quality assurance, corrective action and GrowMeal certification.
Use	The system is designed for LIFEWS reviewers, school leaders, GrowMeal coordinators and authorized evaluators.
Evidence principle	Certification depends on documented implementation and safe, meaningful learning - not the visual appearance of a garden alone.

2. M&E; CYCLE

Baseline	Assess readiness before implementation or at entry into the program.
Routine monitoring	Track weekly operations, teaching delivery, participation, resource use and safety.
Term evaluation	Review learner outcomes, passport/assessment evidence, garden functionality, teacher delivery and operational records.
Improvement	Create corrective actions for gaps and verify closure.
Certification	Apply the certification score only after evidence review and any mandatory safety conditions are checked.
Annual review	Compare terms, identify trends and decide whether certification is maintained, upgraded, placed under improvement or suspended.

3. EVIDENCE SOURCES

School records	Readiness checklist, timetable, roles, inventory, maintenance and incident records.
Teaching evidence	12-week plans, selected resource IDs, teacher observation records and lesson evidence.
Learner evidence	Journals, practical outputs, missions, Ingredient Lab, Farm-to-Food, Food Smart Challenges, assessments and passports.
Garden evidence	Functionality, maintenance, water, labels, access, system records and safe operating condition.
Verification	Use direct observation and traceable records. Photographs may supplement evidence where school consent/privacy procedures permit.

4. SCORING METHOD

Item score	0 = absent/unsafe/not demonstrated; 1 = beginning; 2 = developing; 3 = secure; 4 = exemplary/embedded.
Domain score	Convert the average item score in each domain to a percentage, then multiply by the domain weight.
Total score	Sum weighted domain scores for a maximum of 100.
Evidence rule	A score must be supported by observable or documented evidence. If evidence cannot be verified, score conservatively.
Safety gate	A critical unresolved safeguarding, structural, food-safety or other serious safety issue can prevent certification regardless of total score.

5. CERTIFICATION LEVELS

90-100	GrowMeal Model School - exemplary implementation with strong evidence, safe operations and sustained learning quality.
80-89	GrowMeal Gold School - secure implementation across the system with only minor improvement needs.
70-79	GrowMeal Green School - functioning implementation meeting the core standard, with defined improvement priorities.
55-69	GrowMeal Developing School - partial implementation; corrective action and follow-up review required before full certification.
Below 55	Not Yet Certified - major implementation gaps require improvement and reassessment.
Validity	Certification status should be reviewed at least annually and may be reconsidered earlier if major safety or implementation failures occur.

6. BASELINE ASSESSMENT

Leadership	Is there an accountable school lead and GrowMeal coordinator?
Timetable	Is protected practical learning time available?
Site	Is the proposed garden site safe, accessible and appropriate to the selected level?
Water	Is water sufficiently reliable for the intended garden scale?
Storage	Can tools, inputs and clean food-contact materials be stored appropriately?
Staff	Have responsible teachers/facilitators been identified?
Safety	Are safeguarding, incident, food-safety and tool-use procedures available?
Resources	Are minimum teaching and practical materials available or budgeted?

7. TEACHER DELIVERY OBSERVATION

Opening	Objective and relevant vocabulary are made clear at an age-appropriate level.
Demonstration	New procedures, measurements and safety-critical steps are modeled before learner practice.
Practical learning	Learners perform meaningful work rather than only watching the teacher.
Questioning	Questions move from observation/recall toward evidence, explanation and decision-making appropriate to the level.
Evidence	The lesson produces identifiable learner evidence.
Differentiation	Support and extension preserve access to the core learning objective.
Assessment	Teacher observes/assesses the intended competence and gives useful feedback.
Closure	Learners summarize learning, complete cleanup and understand the next action.

8. LEARNER OUTCOME EVALUATION

Knowledge	Use assessment evidence and appropriate oral/written responses.
Practical competence	Use direct observation and practical evidence; do not infer competence from quizzes alone.
Investigation/data	Review measurement, recording, analysis, graph/model and interpretation evidence appropriate to level.
Mission problem solving	Review how learners use evidence, constraints and reasoning to make decisions.
Progression	Compare results across terms/classes cautiously, noting changes in tasks, gardens, attendance and learner cohorts.

9. GARDEN QUALITY AUDIT

Function	Garden/system is usable for the intended learning purpose.
Safety	Paths, structures, tools, water points and work zones are controlled and safe.
Maintenance	Plants/systems show evidence of routine care; failures are recorded and acted upon.
Learning visibility	Labels, measurement points or other learning features support instruction.
Resource efficiency	Water, materials and reusable resources are managed deliberately.
Data potential	At higher levels, the system supports traceable measurements and repeatable investigation.

10. CORRECTIVE ACTION

Finding	State the specific gap and evidence.
Risk	Classify whether it affects safety, learning quality, operations, records or certification.
Action	Define a concrete corrective action rather than a vague intention.
Owner/date	Assign a responsible person and target date.
Verification	Record evidence that the action was completed and effective.
Escalation	Safety-critical findings require immediate control and cannot wait for routine review.

11. TERM & ANNUAL REPORTING

Term report	Summarize implementation, learner outcomes, garden status, assessment/passport completion, incidents, repairs and corrective actions.
Annual report	Compare terms, certification domains, recurring weaknesses, resource needs and improvement priorities.
Interpretation	Do not treat a single total score as the whole story; examine domain scores and critical findings.
Use	Reports should inform staffing, training, procurement, garden redesign and next-term teaching priorities.

12. CERTIFICATION GOVERNANCE

Evaluator	Certification should be completed by an authorized reviewer who can inspect evidence and the operating environment.
Conflict	Where possible, final certification should include review beyond the teacher who generated the evidence.
Record	Retain scorecard, evidence notes, corrective actions, decision date and certification level.
Appeal/review	Schools may provide additional evidence or request review according to LIFEWS program procedures.
Integrity	Certification marks implementation quality; it should not be issued solely for participation, payment, garden installation or promotional value.

APPENDIX A - SCHOOL CERTIFICATION SCORECARD

D1 - Leadership & Readiness (10%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Leadership approval/accountability		
GrowMeal coordinator active		
Protected timetable		
Roles documented		
Implementation records available		

D2 - Garden Operations & Safety (15%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Garden systems functional		
Water reliable		
Tools controlled		
Maintenance current		
Safety/hygiene procedures followed		

D3 - Teacher Delivery Quality (20%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Objective/vocabulary clear		
Demonstration quality		
Meaningful learner practical work		
Questioning supports reasoning		
Differentiation/feedback evident		

D4 - Learner Participation & Practical Competence (15%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Learners actively participate		
Practical competence observed		
Safe tool/material use		
Learner evidence identifiable		
Learner ownership/responsibility visible		

D5 - Investigation, Data & Problem Solving (15%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Measurements/observations traceable		
Data recording appropriate		

Analysis appropriate to level		
Garden Missions used		
Evidence supports decisions		

D6 - Food Literacy & Resource Stewardship (10%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Ingredient Lab used		
Farm-to-Food used		
Food Smart Challenges used		
Water/resource stewardship taught		
Waste/loss learning evident		

D7 - Assessment, Passport & Moderation (10%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Assessment completed		
Four dimensions assessed		
Rubric used consistently		
Moderation/reassessment evident		
Passports verified		

D8 - Reporting, Improvement & Community Engagement (5%)

Indicator	0-4	Evidence / Finding
Term reporting completed		
Corrective actions tracked		
Improvement decisions documented		
Community engagement appropriate		
Evidence retained		

APPENDIX B - CERTIFICATION DECISION RECORD

School	_____
Review date	_____
Evaluator	_____
Weighted score	_____ / 100
Safety gate	Clear / Not clear
Certification	Model / Gold / Green / Developing / Not Yet Certified
Critical findings	_____
Corrective actions	_____
Follow-up date	_____
Decision authorization	_____